

B2

GRAMMAR LESSON · TIME EXPRESSIONS

By the time

By the time ... — one event finished before another happened (or will happen).

By the time Kullanımı

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

By the time, iki olay arasında bir "yarış" kurar: bir olay gerçekleştiğinde, **diğer olayın ondan önce çoktan tamamlanmış** olduğunu (ya da tamamlanmış olacağını) anlatır. "By the time" bir bağlaç gibi davranır ve genelde sonrasında bir **past perfect** veya **future perfect** yapı gelir — çünkü anlatılan olay, diğer olaydan önce bitmiştir.

The Structure

Formula

By the time + ÖZNE + PAST SIMPLE, ÖZNE + HAD + V3 (past perfect)

By the time + ÖZNE + PRESENT SIMPLE, ÖZNE + WILL HAVE + V3 (future perfect)

"By the time" cümlelerin başında da sonunda da olabilir; anlam değişmez, sadece virgül kullanımı değişir.

Affirmative / Negative / Question

Zaman	By the time cümlesi	Ana cümle
Geçmiş	past simple	had + V3 (past perfect)
Gelecek	present simple	will have + V3 (future perfect)

Word Order

By the time + zaman cümlesi, ana cümle. (Sıra tersine de çevrilebilir, virgül kalkar.)

- By the time she called, I had already left. — O aradığında, ben çoktan gitmiştim.
- I had already left by the time she called. — O aradığında ben çoktan gitmiştim. (sıra ters, virgülsüz)

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **by the time + past simple, ... + past perfect (geçmişte, bir olay diğerinden önce bitmiş) için:** By the time I woke up, everyone had left.
- **by the time + present simple, ... + future perfect (gelecekte, bir olay diğerinden önce bitmiş olacak) için:** By the time you read this, I'll have landed.
- **by the time, genelde "şaşırtıcı" bir hız/gecikme vurgusu için de kullanılır:** By the time the ambulance arrived, it was too late.

When DON'T we use it?

By the time'dan sonra will KULLANMA — zaman bildiren yan cümlelerde (when, before, by the time, as soon as...) gelecek için will değil present simple kullanılır.

✗ By the time you will arrive, I'll have left. → ✓ By the time you arrive, I'll have left.

Geçmişte iki olayı anlatırken ikinci fiili past simple bırakma — sıralamayı netleştirmek için genelde past perfect gerekir.

✗ By the time we got there, the train left. (belirsiz: hangisi önce?) → ✓ By the time we got there, the train had left.

Short Answers

Hızlı kural: By the time'dan sonraki cümle her zaman ŞİMDİKİ ZAMAN MANTIĞIYLA kalır (past simple veya present simple); "bitmiş olma" anlamı HER ZAMAN diğer (ana) cümlede perfect yapı ile verilir.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Biz eve vardığımızda, film çoktan bitmişti." (iki geçmiş olay, biri diğerinden önce) → HANGİ OLAY DAHA ÖNCE BİTTİ? → Film bitmesi (varmamızdan önce) → İKİSİ DE GEÇMİŞTEYSE → by the time + past simple, ... + PAST PERFECT → CÜMLE → "By the time we got home, the film had finished."

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Sen geldiğinde, ben yemeği bitirmiş olacağım." (bir gelecek olay, diğeri ondan önce tamamlanmış olacak) → HANGİ OLAY DAHA SONRA GERÇEKLEŞECEK? → Senin gelmen → İKİSİ DE GELECEKTEYSE → by the time + present simple, ... + FUTURE PERFECT → CÜMLE → "By the time you arrive, I'll have finished cooking."

Examples

TEMEL

- By the time the police arrived, the thief had disappeared. — Polis geldiğinde hırsız çoktan kaybolmuştu.
- By the time we finish this course, we'll have learned 500 new words. — Bu kursu bitirdiğimizde 500 yeni kelime öğrenmiş olacağız.
- By the time I got to the station, the train had left. — İstasyona vardığımda tren çoktan kalkmıştı.

ORTA SEVİYE

- By the time you finish reading this book, you'll have forgotten the first chapter. — Bu kitabı bitirdiğinde ilk bölümü çoktan unutmuş olacaksın.
- By the time the movie started, we had already eaten all the popcorn. — Film başladığında patlamış mısırın hepsini çoktan yemiştik.
- By the time he turns thirty, he'll have visited every country in Europe. — Otuz yaşına geldiğinde Avrupa'daki her ülkeyi ziyaret etmiş olacak.
- By the time I realized my mistake, it was too late to fix it. — Hatamı fark ettiğimde, düzeltmek için çok geçti.

KARŞILAŞTIRMA

- By the time she graduates, she'll have studied medicine for six years. — Mezun olduğunda altı yıldır tıp okumuş olacak.
- She has studied medicine for six years now. — Şu anda altı yıldır tıp okuyor. (present perfect, by the time yok)
- By the time the guests arrived, we had cleaned the whole house. — Misafirler geldiğinde tüm evi temizlemiştik.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

By the time (bu konu)

İki olay arasındaki sıralamayı bir cümleyle kurar: biri gerçekleştiğinde diğeri çoktan bitmiş olur/olacaktır.
By the time I arrived, she had left.

By vs Until

By tek bir son tarihi (deadline), until ise bir eylemin o ana kadar kesintisiz sürdüğünü anlatır — iki olay arasında bir ilişki kurmaz, tek bir zaman noktası verir.
Finish it by six. / Wait here until six.

→ By vs Until konusuna git

Visual Timeline

Timeline: olay 1 önce biter (had + V3 / will have + V3) ·· olay 2 (by the time + past/present simple)

Common Mistakes

✗ By the time you will arrive, I'll have cooked dinner.

✓ **By the time you arrive, I'll have cooked dinner.**

WHY? Türkçede "geleceksin" gelecek zaman olduğu için öğrenciler İngilizcede de will kullanmak ister; ama zaman bildiren yan cümlelerde (by the time dahil) gelecek için present simple kullanılır, will değil.

✗ By the time we arrived, the film finished.

✓ **By the time we arrived, the film had finished.**

WHY? İki geçmiş olayı sadece past simple ile vermek hangisinin önce bittiğini belirsiz bırakır; film bizim varmamızdan ÖNCE bittiği için past perfect gerekir.

✗ By the time I will finish university, I will have got a job.

✓ **By the time I finish university, I will have got a job.**

WHY? Sadece ana cümlede (sonuç cümlesinde) will/future perfect kullanılır; by the time cümlesinde present simple kalır.

✗ By the time she comes, I will finish the report.

✓ **By the time she comes, I will have finished the report.**

WHY? Sadece "will" kullanmak, iki olayın aynı anda olacağı izlenimini verir; ama raporun onun gelişinden ÖNCE bitmiş olması gerektiği için future perfect (will have finished) kullanılır.

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 21

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. Find the mistake and correct it.

By the time you ^A will arrive ^B , I'll have cooked dinner. ^C

Correction: _____

2. Find the mistake and correct it.

By the time we arrived, the film ^A finished ^B . ^C

Correction: _____

3. By the time I woke up, everyone _____ .

a) has left

b) left

c) had left

d) leaves

PART B · PRACTICE

4. By the time you read this, I _____ .

a) 'll have landed

b) land

c) landed

d) 'm landing

5. By the time the ambulance arrived, it _____ too late. (be)

6. Find the mistake and correct it.

By the time I ^A will finish ^B university, I will have got a job. ^C

Correction: _____

7. By the time she _____ , I'll have finished.

a) comes

b) will come

c) has came

d) came

8. You got to the station at 9:05. Your train left at 9:00.

What do you say?

a) By the time I got to the station, the train has left.

b) By the time I got to the station, the train left.

c) By the time I got to the station, the train had left.

d) By the time I get to the station, the train had left.

9. "By the time we got home, the rain had stopped." When did the rain stop?

a) after we got home

b) before we got home

c) it didn't stop

d) when we left

10. By the time he's 30, he _____ his own company.

a) started

b) starts

c) has started

d) will have started

11. By the time I _____ (get) to the party, all the food had gone.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

12. By the time we _____ the cinema, the film had started.
a) reached b) reach c) had reached d) will reach

13. By the time you get this letter, I _____ Turkey.
a) will have left b) had left c) leave d) left

14. By the time the police arrived, the thieves _____ (escape).

15. Find the mistake and correct it.

By the time she comes, I ^A finish ^B my homework. ^C

Correction: _____

16. By the time I _____ my coffee, it was cold.
a) had drunk b) will drink c) drink d) drank

17. Your plane lands at 10. Your friend's meeting finishes at 9.

What does your friend say?

- a) By the time you land, my meeting will have finished.
- b) By the time you landed, my meeting will have finished.
- c) By the time you will land, my meeting will finish.
- d) By the time you land, my meeting had finished.

18. "By the time I'm 40, I'll have paid off my loan." What does it mean?

- a) I'll start paying at 40.
- b) I paid it at 40.
- c) I'll never pay it.
- d) The loan will be paid before or when I'm 40.

19. By the time the guests _____, we had cleaned the whole house.
a) arrive b) arrived c) had arrived d) will arrive

20. Which sentence is correct?

- a) By the time we will finish, it will be dark.
- b) By the time we finish, it will be dark.
- c) By the time we finish, it had been dark.
- d) By the time we finished, it will be dark.

21. Rewrite with "by the time": "The concert ended before we arrived."

_____, the concert had ended.

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **B — will arrive → arrive** — by the time + present simple.
2. **B — finished → had finished** — Geçmiş → past perfect.
3. **c) had left** — past simple + past perfect.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **a) 'll have landed** — Gelecek → future perfect.
5. **was** — Durum → past simple (was).
6. **B — will finish → finish** — by the time + present.
7. **a) comes** — by the time + present simple.
8. **c) By the time I got to the station, the train had left.** — Geçmiş → past simple + past perfect.
9. **b) before we got home** — had stopped → varmadan önce.
10. **d) will have started** — Gelecek → future perfect.
11. **got** — by the time + past simple.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

12. **a) reached** — by the time + past simple.
13. **a) will have left** — Gelecek → future perfect.
14. **had escaped** — past perfect.
15. **B — finish → will have finished** — Gelecek → will have + V3.
16. **d) drank** — by the time + past simple.
17. **a) By the time you land, my meeting will have finished.** — Gelecek → present + future perfect.
18. **d) The loan will be paid before or when I'm 40.** — future perfect → o zamana kadar tamamlanmış.
19. **b) arrived** — Geçmiş → past simple.
20. **b) By the time we finish, it will be dark.** — by the time + present, future.
21. **By the time we arrived, the concert had ended.** — By the time + past simple, past perfect.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırma):

<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b2/by-the-time>